

Google clocks 100 million Android activations

Google recently announced that over 100 million Android devices have now been activated, with 400,000 new tablets and phones being switched on every day. "Over the past two and a half years, we've shipped eight releases of Android and there are now more than 310 Android devices around the world, of all shapes and sizes," Hugo Barra, product management director, Android, shared at the Google I/O developer conference in San Francisco.



ForgeRock launches OpenICF

ForgeRock, the open source identity-oriented middleware company, has launched a new open source community, OpenICF, to host multi-purpose connectors using the Identity Connector Framework (ICF). The OpenICF Project will make interoperability between identity, compliance and risk management solutions easier and more reliable by providing a consistent generic layer between applications and resources. The community can be found at <http://openicf.forgerock.org/>.

The ICF was originally created by Sun Microsystems and focused on providing connectors for identity provisioning.

Google Earth for Android tablets

Google has announced the latest version of the Google Earth app for tablets that are powered by Android OS. "With the recent release of tablets based on Android 3.0, we wanted to take full advantage of the large screens and powerful processors that this exciting new breed of tablets had to offer," the company said in a blog post. The update adds support for fully textured 3D buildings and features like a new action bar up top, enabling easier access to search, the option to "fly to your location" and layers such as Places, Panoramio photos and Wikipedia.



Galaxy S II hits 3 million pre-orders

Samsung's Galaxy S II smartphone has received three million pre-orders around the globe. With over 120,000 units already sold in Korea alone during the first day of its launch and with up to 120 countries waiting for the smartphone, the company is likely to reach its target of selling a total of 10 million Samsung Galaxy S II smartphones by the end of the year. It packs an 11-cm (4.3-inch) Super AMOLED display with a resolution of 480 x 800 pixels, a dual core 1.2 GHz processor, two cameras, A-GPS, Bluetooth 3.0, USB 2.0, 802.11 a/b/g/n Wi-Fi and optional NFC.



Chromebooks to be available from June 15

At the recently held Google I/O event in San Francisco, the Internet titan took the wraps off

its Chrome-powered notebooks. It also announced plans to bring



out notebook computers running the company's new operating system on June 15. Built by Samsung and Acer, the notebooks will run Web-based apps and store files in the cloud instead of on a hard drive. "Your apps, games, photos, music, movies and documents will be accessible wherever you are and you won't need to worry about losing your computer or forgetting to back up files," Google said in a blog post.

Samsung Electronics will sell a version with a 30.7 cm (12.1 inch) screen and Wi-Fi for \$429, and another model with 3G connectivity for \$499. The Acer Chromebook, featuring a 29.5 cm (11.6 inch) screen, will cost \$399. Both Chromebooks will be powered by dual-core Atom processors made by Intel. The companies claim that both will boot-up within eight seconds.

ViewSonic to launch first 17.8 cm (7") Honeycomb tablet

ViewSonic is reportedly preparing to launch the world's first 17.8 cm (7 inch) tablet based



on Honeycomb. The ViewPad 7x will weigh 380 grams and sport a dual-core Nvidia Tegra 2 chip, dual cameras, a HDMI port and HSPA+ support. It is not known whether it will have the freshly launched Honeycomb 3.1, or the initial 3.0 version of the Android mobile OS designed specifically for tablets.